KOR STRUCTURAL · BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT

Defence Security Clearance

What it is, how long it takes, and the one thing to decide today.

$0 TO APPLY

2–4 mo DOS

6+ mo FSC — THE LONG POLE

THE RULE

A clearance cannot be applied for cold.

Since the 2022 reform a firm cannot self-initiate a federal security clearance. It must be SPONSORED against a live requirement — either DCC sponsors directly, by email citing a posted solicitation number, or a CSP-registered prime with an active sensitive contract sponsors its sub-consultant.

And it does not block being named on a team.

Primes may NOT require an existing clearance to include KOR on a forming team. Teams are named first; clearances follow. Every gate — clearance and now cyber certification — attaches at or after contract award. The cost of preparing is near zero; the cost of being unprepared is the whole pursuit.

THE FOUR LEVELS — TWO FOR THE FIRM, TWO FOR THE PEOPLE

DOS — Designated Organization Screening

FIRM. Protected-level work; personnel screened to Reliability. ~2–4 months. Free, bar fingerprints at ~$40–65 a person.

FSC — Facility Security Clearance (Secret)

FIRM. Classified work; personnel to Secret. ~6+ months — 3 to 9 reported end-to-end. Free. This is the long pole.

Reliability status — per person

The baseline for most design work. Weeks, once the organisation is cleared.

Secret — per person

Classified files. Months. Typically 2–3 key engineers.

WHICH ONE DOES KOR NEED?

There is no discipline-level rule.

Each contract's Security Requirements Check List decides. Protected-B design work points to DOS; the jetty file plausibly demands FSC plus Secret people. Plan for FSC; celebrate if DOS suffices.

SPONSORSHIP MECHANICS

Route 1 — DCC sponsors directly

An email to its industrial-security sponsorship address citing the posted solicitation number.

Route 2 — a prime sponsors its sub

A CSP-registered prime holding an active sensitive contract sponsors KOR.

Timing — submit the week a team names KOR, not at award

The trigger is being named, not winning. Waiting for award wastes the 2–6 months the screening takes.

DECIDE TODAY

Name a Company Security Officer and an alternate.

Two roles must exist inside KOR before any sponsorship can be submitted: a CSO and an ACSO. It is a designation plus training — not a hire, and free. Nothing else on this page can start until they exist.

⚠ Open question: was this already done?

The July brief listed naming the CSO and ACSO as a “this week” action. The August revalidation pass records that week as passed with the outcome UNKNOWN. Confirming it either way takes one conversation and is the first move.

Source: KOR-Defence-Qualification-Path-2026-08-27 §04, verified against DCC and PSPC guidance. Facts as at 27 August 2026 · Building Defence 2026 (DND/DCC Industry Days) is 9–10 November, Ottawa or virtual.